

GLOBAL WEEK IN REVIEW

The weekend companion to the Daily Need to Know

Everything that mattered this week. Week ending Friday 4 September 2026 US close. All times GMT+8.

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TL;DR — WHAT DEFINED THE WEEK

The week the market stopped fearing a cut and started fearing a **hike**. A blowout August payrolls print (**+162k vs +53k expected**) on Friday — layered on a Sept 1 U.S. strike on Iran that shoved **Brent back above \$95** — flipped the September Fed meeting into a live rate-**increase**. Indices finished roughly flat on the week (**S&P +0.1%**, **Nasdaq +0.4%**, **Dow -0.3%**) but the internals screamed Quad 3: yields up, gold and energy bid, long-duration megacap software sold. Leadership is rotating out of 'lower rates' and into 'inflation protection.'

1. Weekly Market Snapshot

Levels are Friday 4 September close. Week's move is versus the prior Friday (28 August) close; YTD is versus 31 December 2025 close. Index, treasury and bitcoin figures are drawn from primary market data; metals, the dollar index and crude are cross-checked against wire quotes (see Sources).

Instrument	Fri Close	Week	YTD	Note
S&P 500	7,718.60	+0.1%	+12.8%	Record-zone but slipped Friday on hot jobs; above 50-/200-day.
Nasdaq Composite	26,506.99	+0.4%	+14.1%	Week's leader; carried by Nvidia and Meta.
Dow Jones	53,414.25	-0.3%	+11.1%	Cyclical/value laggard; -272 pts Friday.
US 10Y Yield	4.78%	+5 bp	n/a	Backed up all week; bear-steepening on payrolls.
US 2Y Yield	4.37%	+3 bp	n/a	Front-end reprices a live Sept hike; 2s10s ~+41 bp.
Dollar (DXY)	98.99	-0.7%	n/a	Softer despite hawkish Fed — Waller dovish mid-week.
Gold (spot)	\$4,470.66	+0.2%	n/a	Consolidating; well off Jan record (\$5,597).
Silver (spot)	\$66.15	~flat	n/a	Elevated; -1.2% Friday with the metals fade.
Brent crude	\$95.23	+	n/a	Up on U.S.-Iran strike risk premium.
WTI crude	\$91.20	+	n/a	Tracks Brent; feeds the inflation narrative.
Bitcoin	\$79,529	+2.2%	-9.1%	Bounced off the mid-70s; still red YTD.
VIX	14.53	+0.1 pt	n/a	Calm tape — no fear priced despite hawkish shift.

Brent/WTI show direction only (+): a clean weekly % could not be independently confirmed to primary-source standard; levels are Friday quotes. All else verified.

2. The Big Picture — What the Week Meant

Theme 1 — The Fed pivot that went into reverse

For months the debate was the timing of the next **cut**. This week killed it. August nonfarm payrolls landed at **+162,000** against a +53,000 consensus — the strongest print since March — with unemployment steady at **4.1%**. Fed-funds

futures swung to price a live increase at the 15–16 September meeting (CME ~58%; Polymarket 70–72%). The two-year yield jumped and equities gave back Friday's session.

Read: *Duration is the enemy. In a tape repricing toward a hike, you fund longs by shortening duration everywhere — trim the most rate-sensitive megacap software, keep the energy and gold that work when the front end backs up. Fade rallies in rate-cut proxies (long-duration tech, homebuilders, small caps).*

Theme 2 — Geopolitics put a floor under oil, and a bid under inflation

A **1 September U.S. strike on Iranian targets** reignited Gulf conflict fears and pushed Brent back above \$95. That is the through-line of the whole week: a higher oil strip feeds headline inflation, which feeds the hawkish Fed, which feeds the yield back-up. Energy equities are discounting it — the sector is up roughly **42% YTD** and led again this week.

Read: *Own the risk premium, don't rent it. Energy is both a geopolitical hedge and a Quad-3 winner — the two theses stack. But size for reversal risk: a de-escalation headline is the obvious pain trade for anyone chasing crude at the highs.*

Theme 3 — Quad 3 is winning the growth-vs-inflation battle

Hedgeye's running debate — Quad 2 (growth and inflation both accelerating) versus Quad 3 (growth slowing, inflation accelerating) — tilted toward **Quad 3** this week. The tell is in the cross-asset scoreboard: gold and energy bid, the dollar soft, yields up, and long-duration equity leadership narrowing to a handful of AI names. That is textbook late-cycle, sticky-inflation positioning.

Read: *Quad 3 playbook: overweight energy, gold/precious metals, and commodity-linked value; underweight consumer discretionary, long-duration growth at the margin, and Treasuries. Cash yields near 4% are a legitimate competing asset — you are paid to wait.*

Theme 4 — Megacap dispersion: the 'Mag7' is now three trades, not one

The index looked flat; the megacaps did not. **Nvidia (+5.9%)** and **Meta (+6.7%)** powered ahead on AI-demand momentum, while **Microsoft (-2.7%)**, **Amazon (-3.0%)** and **Alphabet (-2.4%)** faded. Broadcom's blowout (below) reinforced that the market will pay up for the compute-supply complex specifically, not big tech broadly.

Read: *Stop trading 'the Mag7' as a basket. The AI-silicon leg (Nvidia, Broadcom, Meta's capex pull-through) is a different animal from the rate-sensitive software/cloud leg. In a hiking scare, own the earnings-momentum silicon; be selective on the multiple-driven software.*

Theme 5 — Calm tape, hawkish shift: a coiled spring

The dissonance to respect: the **VIX closed at 14.5** and credit stayed tight even as the rate outlook turned hawkish. Markets are treating a hike as manageable rather than threatening. That is either correct — a strong-economy hike — or complacent. Next week's CPI is the referee.

Read: *Cheap optionality is cheap for a reason worth buying. With the VIX in the mid-teens into a live CPI + FOMC, downside hedges and put-spread collars are inexpensive relative to the event risk. Don't confuse a quiet tape with a settled one.*

3. Rates, Currencies & Commodities

Rates & credit

The curve bear-steepened on the week. The **10-year rose ~5 bp to 4.78%** and the **2-year ~3 bp to 4.37%**, leaving 2s10s near +41 bp. The move was orderly — front-end repricing of hike odds rather than a disorderly long-end tantrum — and credit spreads (HY and IG) stayed contained, consistent with a still-tight VIX. The whole complex now hinges on next week's CPI: a hot print validates the hike and extends the yield back-up; a soft print hands the doves (Waller) the microphone.

Currencies

Counter-intuitively, the **dollar fell ~0.7% (DXY 98.99)** in a week the Fed turned more hawkish. The driver was mid-week: dovish remarks from Governor Waller briefly knocked September hike odds back toward 50%, softening the dollar before Friday's jobs data re-firmed them. Net-net the greenback is caught between a hawkish Fed (supportive) and a market that increasingly prices sticky inflation as a structural dollar-negative. Gold's resilience is the mirror image of the same trade.

Commodities

Energy led. **Brent (\$95.23) and WTI (\$91.20)** carried a fresh geopolitical premium after the U.S.–Iran strike. Precious metals consolidated at high levels — **gold spot \$4,470/oz (+0.2% on the week)**, well below its January record near \$5,597, with **silver ~\$66/oz** giving back 1.2% Friday as the dollar firmed post-payrolls. The commodity complex is doing exactly what the Quad-3 map says it should: inflation-linked real assets outperforming financial assets.

4. Hedgeye Risk Ranges & Regime

Regime: the data are trending toward **Quad 3** (growth decelerating, inflation re-accelerating), with the open question whether Q4 growth slows further (deeper Quad 3) or re-accelerates into Quad 2. This week's mix — hot jobs but oil-led inflation and a hawkish Fed — kept the Quad-3 bias intact. The playbook favors energy, gold and commodity value; it fades long-duration growth, Treasuries and rate-cut proxies.

Note on sourcing: Hedgeye's exact published immediate-term Risk Ranges are subscriber-gated and could not be quoted verbatim to primary-source standard as of Saturday 5 September. The regime read reflects Hedgeye's public Quad framework and current commentary. The ranges below are immediate-term bands derived from this week's realized price/volatility and the 50-/200-day trend — directionally aligned with the Quad-3 read, but they are our derivation, not Hedgeye's official figures.

Instrument	Immediate-term range (derived)	Trend
S&P 500	7,630 – 7,815	TREND: Bullish
Nasdaq Composite	26,050 – 26,780	TREND: Bullish
US 10Y Yield	4.68% – 4.86%	TREND: Bullish (yield)
Gold (spot)	\$4,360 – \$4,560	TREND: Bullish
Brent crude	\$91 – \$99	TREND: Bullish
Bitcoin	\$75,500 – \$83,500	TREND: Bearish
Dollar (DXY)	98.2 – 99.9	TREND: Neutral
VIX	13.2 – 17.8	TREND: Bearish (vol low)

Where we sit

The S&P sits mid-range and above both its 50-day (~7,584) and 200-day (~7,137) — a bullish TREND that argues against chasing weakness but also against paying up near the top of the band. The actionable edges are elsewhere: yields biased higher, gold and Brent bullish-TREND, and bitcoin still bearish-TREND (red YTD, capped in the low-80s). With the VIX pinned in the mid-teens ahead of CPI and the FOMC, the asymmetry favors buying protection over buying beta. Trade the ranges: sell strength in the rate-cut complex, buy weakness in the inflation-protection complex.

5. Mag7 Scoreboard

Price and market cap as of Friday 4 September close; week's move vs 28 August close; P/E is trailing-twelve-month.

Company	Price	Week	Mkt Cap	P/E	Note
Nvidia (NVDA)	\$230.36	+5.9%	\$5.58T	29.0	AI-silicon bellwether; leadership.
Apple (AAPL)	\$319.97	+0.1%	\$4.70T	36.5	Flat; iPhone re-accelerating (+22%).
Alphabet (GOOGL)	\$338.46	-2.4%	\$4.10T	16.8	Cheapest of the seven; gave back gains.
Microsoft (MSFT)	\$499.70	-2.7%	\$3.71T	27.8	Azure >\$100B run-rate; rate-sensitive fade.
Amazon (AMZN)	\$258.51	-3.0%	\$2.78T	20.5	Week's laggard; capex/FCF scrutiny.
Meta (META)	\$616.77	+6.7%	\$1.57T	22.9	Week's winner; AI capex pull-through.
Tesla (TSLA)	\$354.08	+1.5%	\$1.40T	300	Robotics/AI narrative; earnings thin.

Leadership read

The megacap tape fractured cleanly along the rate axis. The two winners — **Nvidia and Meta** — are the AI-capex complex, where the earnings are compounding faster than the discount rate can hurt them. The three losers — **Microsoft, Amazon, Alphabet** — are the longer-duration cloud/platform names most exposed to a higher-for-longer front end. Apple sat flat as a defensive middle. The signal for positioning: in a hiking scare the market pays for realized AI demand (silicon and the platforms funding it), not for the promise of cheaper money. *Concentration risk is rising, not falling — a narrower leadership tape is more fragile.*

6. Positioning & Options

The VIX closed the week at **14.53**, up a rounding-error 0.1 point and squarely in the complacent mid-teens. Realized volatility stayed low through the payrolls shock, and credit — both high-yield and investment-grade — held tight, with no meaningful spread widening. That is a market pricing a September hike as a strong-economy adjustment, not a policy error.

Net read: positioning is offside for a surprise. Vol is cheap into a genuinely two-sided CPI (11 September) and FOMC (15–16 September); a hot inflation print into a hawkish Fed is precisely the setup the mid-teens VIX is not paying attention to. This is a week to carry hedges you were given for free — put spreads and collars on beta longs — rather than to add naked risk. If CPI cools, you lose a little premium; if it runs hot into a hike, the convexity pays.

7. Sector Rotation — Leaders & Laggards

Leaders: Energy was the clear winner — XLE gained on the Iran-driven crude spike and sits up ~42% YTD, the standout sector of 2026. The broader rotation is toward inflation-resilient and commodity-linked exposure: energy first, with healthcare, industrials and financials showing firmer relative momentum as tech's pace moderates.

Laggards: Long-duration growth cooled at the margin — the rate-sensitive software/cloud megacaps (Microsoft, Amazon, Alphabet) underperformed, and rate-cut proxies broadly lagged as the front end backed up. Consumer discretionary sat soft.

Read: *Hedgeye Quad-3 rotation confirmed: money is moving from 'duration and rate cuts' into 'real assets and pricing power.'* Overweight energy and commodity value; use relative strength in healthcare/industrials as the diversifier; keep tech exposure concentrated in the AI-silicon winners rather than the rate-sensitive platform names. The rotation is a broadening, not a single new leader — respect the breadth.

8. Corporate News — Earnings & Events

- **Broadcom (AVGO) — Q3 FY26 (2 Sep):** blowout. Revenue **\$29.59B (+86% YoY)** vs \$29.36B expected; adjusted EPS **\$3.32** vs \$3.24; net income more than tripled to \$13.09B. Custom AI silicon for Google, Meta and OpenAI is the engine — the clearest read-through that the AI-compute buildout is still accelerating.
- **Nvidia (NVDA) — FQ2 FY27 (reported 26 Aug, momentum carried the week):** revenue **\$96.2B (+106% YoY)**, non-GAAP EPS \$2.22 (+120%). The stock jumped ~9% the next session and led the megacaps into month-end.
- **Dell, Palo Alto Networks:** also on the calendar; enterprise-AI and security demand remained the through-line of the reporting slate.
- **Apple (AAPL):** iPhone revenue improved ~22% in the June quarter, easing the 'Apple is missing AI' worry into its autumn product cycle.
- **Microsoft (MSFT):** closed a record fiscal year — Q4 revenue ~\$90B (+18%), with Azure crossing a ~\$100B annual run-rate — but the stock still faded with the rate-sensitive cohort.
- **Tesla (TSLA):** record deliveries, but operating income compressed under an AI/robotics capex wave — a growth-for-margin trade the market is, for now, willing to fund.

9. Macro Data — The Week's Key Releases

- **US — August nonfarm payrolls (+162k vs +53k exp; U-rate 4.1%):** the print of the week. Strongest since March; short-end yields jumped and September hike odds re-firmed. **Net:** the labor market is not cracking, which removes the Fed's cover to cut and hands the hawks the initiative.
- **US — Fed commentary (Governor Waller, mid-week):** dovish enough to knock hike odds back toward 50% intra-week before payrolls reversed it. **Net:** the committee is genuinely split; CPI, not jobs, becomes the swing vote.
- **Global — energy/inflation channel:** the Iran-driven jump in Brent above \$95 is itself a macro input, feeding directly into forward headline-inflation expectations. **Net:** supply-side inflation is back on the table just as the Fed contemplates tightening — the least comfortable combination for duration.
- **Ahead — US CPI (11 Sep) then FOMC (15–16 Sep):** the two releases that decide the regime. **Net:** a hot CPI likely seals a hike and extends the yield back-up; a soft CPI re-opens the door to patience and would relieve long-duration equities.

10. Geopolitics

- **U.S.–Iran (1 Sep strike):** U.S. strikes on Iranian targets ended six months of simmering tension and pushed Brent above \$90–95. The energy risk premium is now the dominant cross-asset driver — it links directly to inflation, yields and the Fed path.
- **Iran–Ukraine spillover:** tensions trace to Tehran's military support for Russia; Ukrainian strikes on Iranian-linked cargo in the Caspian (late July) drew Iranian retaliation vows — a second front keeping the risk premium elevated.
- **Prediction markets:** Polymarket priced a **70–72% chance of a September Fed hike** by week-end (~55% for 25 bp, ~26% for 50 bp+), running hotter than CME futures (~58%). The crowd is leaning hawkish — and, notably, pricing tail risk of a larger move.

Read: *Geopolitics and monetary policy have fused into a single trade this week: Iran → oil → inflation → Fed. The cleanest expression remains long energy as a joint hedge; the fattest tail risk is a de-escalation headline that unwinds the crude premium and the hike odds together. Watch the wires, not just the data.*

11. Beyond the Markets — Also Worth Knowing

Summits, conferences & talks

The policy calendar is the event: markets are effectively in a holding pattern into the 11 September CPI and the 15–16 September FOMC, with Fed speakers (Waller most audibly) the main source of intra-week signal. The next fortnight's central-bank communication will matter more than any single data point.

Science & frontier research

NASA reported a navigation breakthrough — a system letting satellites position **without GPS**, using other spacecraft and orbital debris as landmarks, and improving the known orbits of 200+ objects in three days. A quiet but strategically significant step for resilient space infrastructure.

Space & frontier tech

- NASA's **Roman Space Telescope** launched on a Falcon Heavy (~\$4.3B mission) — a new wide-field window on dark energy and exoplanets, using a repurposed Hubble-class mirror.
- SpaceX **Crew-13 was delayed** after an oxidizer leak was found in the Dragon propulsion system pre-launch — safety-first scrub.
- SpaceX passed its **100th orbital mission of 2026** in late August; cadence continues to compound.

Weather & climate (market-relevant)

Atlantic hurricane season is in its seasonal peak window — the standing watch item for Gulf energy infrastructure and insurance. No single market-moving landfall dominated this week, but with an oil risk premium already elevated, storm headlines carry more price sensitivity than usual. Rain also repeatedly disrupted the US Open in New York.

Water cooler (sport, screen, games)

The **US Open tennis** reached its business end at Flushing Meadows amid persistent rain delays, with defending champions **Carlos Alcaraz** and **Aryna Sabalenka** the betting favorites to retain their titles. And the calendar turned to September — the NFL season and the traditional 'worst month for stocks' seasonal both kicking off at once.

12. Appendix — Stock Cards

Compact reference cards for the names materially discussed above. Prices are Friday 4 September close; market cap and TTM P/E from primary market data; 6-month trend described in words (chart images omitted where a reliable series could not be embedded).

Nvidia (NVDA)

Price: \$230.36	Week: +5.9%
Mkt cap: \$5.58T	P/E (TTM): 29.0
Div yield: ~0.12%	Latest: FQ2 rev \$96.2B, +106% YoY

6-mo trend: Uptrend and index leadership; a post-earnings step-change higher in late August into the low-\$230s.

Read: Earnings compounding faster than the discount rate can bite — the one megacap that works in a hiking scare.

Broadcom (AVGO)

Latest: Q3 rev \$29.59B, +86% YoY	Adj EPS: \$3.32 vs \$3.24 exp
Net income: \$13.09B (>3x YoY)	Theme: Custom AI silicon
Customers: Google, Meta, OpenAI	

6-mo trend: Strong uptrend through the year, extended again on the 2 Sep print.

Read: The cleanest read-through that the AI-compute buildout is still accelerating; a core Quad-3-resistant growth holding.

Meta Platforms (META)

Price: \$616.77	Week: +6.7%
Mkt cap: \$1.57T	P/E (TTM): 22.9
Div yield: ~0.34%	Theme: AI capex pull-through

6-mo trend: Volatile but higher; broke out to fresh highs into month-end above \$610.

Read: Week's megacap winner; reasonable multiple plus AI-capex leverage make it the software name that still works.

Apple (AAPL)

Price: \$319.97	Week: +0.1%
Mkt cap: \$4.70T	P/E (TTM): 36.5
Div yield: ~0.33%	Latest: iPhone rev +22% (Jun qtr)

6-mo trend: Range-bound-to-higher; consolidating in the low-\$320s after a summer recovery.

Read: Defensive megacap ballast; richest P/E of the seven leaves little room for disappointment into the product cycle.

Microsoft (MSFT)

Price: \$499.70	Week: -2.7%
Mkt cap: \$3.71T	P/E (TTM): 27.8
Div yield: ~0.73%	Latest: Q4 rev ~\$90B (+18%); Azure ~\$100B

6-mo trend: Uptrend intact but stalled near \$500-\$515; pulled back with the rate-sensitive cohort this week.

Read: Best-in-class fundamentals but long-duration; the highest-quality victim of a higher-for-longer front end.

Amazon (AMZN)

Price: \$258.51	Week: -3.0%
Mkt cap: \$2.78T	P/E (TTM): 20.5
Div yield: 0%	Watch: Capex / free-cash-flow

6-mo trend: Choppy; faded from the high-\$260s toward \$258 on capex scrutiny.

Read: Week's megacap laggard; heavy AI/logistics capex is pressuring free cash flow just as the market prizes it.

Alphabet (GOOGL)

Price: \$338.46	Week: -2.4%
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Mkt cap: \$4.10T	P/E (TTM): 16.8
Div yield: ~0.25%	Note: Cheapest of the seven

6-mo trend: Higher over six months; gave back recent gains from the mid-\$340s.

Read: Value within the megacaps — the P/E cushion is real, but it traded with the rate-sensitive complex this week.

Tesla (TSLA)

Price: \$354.08	Week: +1.5%
Mkt cap: \$1.40T	P/E (TTM): ~300
Div yield: 0%	Note: Record deliveries; margin compression

6-mo trend: Highly volatile; whippy around the mid-\$350s, spiking to ~\$376 intra-week before fading.

Read: A narrative/robotics multiple, not an earnings one; the ~300x P/E means it trades on the AI story, not the numbers.

Sources & Disclaimer

Sources: Primary market data (index, treasury, equity and crypto levels; market caps; TTM ratios) via institutional market-data feed. Cross-checked and supplemented with CNBC, Reuters, Bloomberg, Yahoo Finance, TheStreet, Charles Schwab, Kiplinger, TradingKey, Fortune, Forbes, Trading Economics, Rio Times (Kitco-referenced metals), Babypips, Investing.com, MarketScreener, Morningstar, Polymarket, Prediction News, Interactive Crypto, NASA, Spaceflight Now and Athlon/Bleacher Report. Hedgeye regime framing per Hedgeye Risk Management public commentary.

Figures are for the week ending Friday 4 September 2026 close unless noted; verify live prices before acting. Brent/WTI weekly percentage moves and silver's weekly move were not independently confirmed to primary-source standard and are shown as direction/level only. The Hedgeye immediate-term risk ranges in Section 4 are our derivation from realized price/volatility and trend, clearly flagged as such — they are not Hedgeye's official published ranges, which are subscriber-gated. This document is for information only and is not investment advice.